

STATS AND FACTS

While the massive tyrannosaurids dominated the Northern Hemisphere during the Late Cretaceous Period, abelisaurids such as the fast-moving *Carnotaurus* were the top predators in the Southern Hemisphere.

WEIGHT



At 4,409 lb (2,000 kg), *Carnotaurus* weighed about the same as a modern-day rhinoceros.

SKULL LENGTH



Carnotaurus's skull was 19½ in (50 cm) in length, about one-third of the height of an average human male.

**FASTEST
LARGE THEROPOD**

Speeding through

Research suggests that *Carnotaurus*'s tailbones anchored large leg-pulling muscles, which may have propelled the creature to high speeds. The top speed of this theropod is believed to have been about 35 mph (56 kph)—about the same as that of a leopard.

MEGA RACER

CARNOTAURUS

This formidable abelisaurid (a type of large theropod) stalked the woodlands and forests of Late Cretaceous South America. *Carnotaurus* is known from the fossils of one very well-preserved skeleton that includes an almost intact skull. This skull, which had a pair of unusual brow horns and was lined with small, serrated teeth, was probably the creature's main weapon. *Carnotaurus* had small arms that were of limited use and lacked a moveable elbow or wrist bones. Its long tail and hefty hind legs were equipped with strong muscles that enabled it to run swiftly, making it the fastest large theropod of its time.

